7. https://en.wikisource.org/wiki/On_the_Historical_Unity_of_Russians_and_Ukrainians
8. Averil Cameron in *The Byzantines* writes that the Russian Vladimir's choice of Christianity was only made after '…research about the merits of Islam, Roman Catholicism and the Orthodoxy represented by Byzantium'. Ibid., p. 173.
9. Derek Wilson, *Charlemagne, The Great Adventure* (Hutchinson, London 2005).
10. It was much later that the term Byzantine was (wrongly) assigned a negative meaning. Averil Cameron in *The Byzantines* notes that the *Oxford English Reference Dictionary* explains the term with 'extremely complicated, inflexible or carried on by underhand means'. ibid., p. 3. The same author also draws attention to the fact that even Byzantine studies, as an academic discipline, continue to be discriminated against. (see p. 5).
11. For more details on the supremacy of Byzantium see Warren Treadgold, *A Concise History of Byzantium*, Palgrave, 2001.
12. Angus Maddison, *The World Economy: Historical Statistics* (OECD, 2003). The GDP per capita is estimated taking the 1990 world economy as the measuring stick. Consequently, the calculated 'currency' is called '1990 international Geary-Khamis dollars'.